First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.*

First Congregational Church Vision Statement

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

First Congregational Church Mission Statement

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office:
M: 10-12, **Tu**: 9-2, **W**: 10-12, **Th**: 9-12 & 1-5, **F**: 10-12
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours: By Appointment
Monday is Pastor Jessica's Sabbath.
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent pastoral matters call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

Our worship service is broadcast over the local public access channel 1079 on Sundays at 4 PM.

Reader: Alan Shannon
Acolytes: Mykala Pryor & Ada Sanders

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans
An open and affirming community.



"We welcome you and serve all through faith."

Worship with us:
August 25, 2024
10 am

Rev. Jessica Moore, Pastor
Stephan Conrady, Organist
Monica Newton, Office Manager
27 Church Street, St. Albans, VT 05478
802-524-4555
info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
www.firstcongregationalstalbans.org

FOURTEENTH SUNDAY AFTER PENTECOST AUGUST 25, 2024

WE GATHER AS GOD'S PEOPLE

Centering Words:
"Life, he realized, was much like a song. In the beginning there is mystery, in the end there is confirmation, but it's in the middle where all the emotion resides to make the whole thing worthwhile." — Nicholas Sparks, *The Last Song*

❖ BEGINNING OF SERVICE ❖

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

PRELUDE *Wedding Waltz* (for Claudia) S. Conrady

WELCOME AND ANNOUNCEMENTS

Call To Worship

One: Within this community

All: We experience God's unconditional love

One: Within this community

All: We rejoice in the risen Christ

One: Within this community

All: We awaken to the Holy Spirit

One: Within this community

All: We join together in worship

Morning Prayer[1] **(Unison)**

L**ovely God, you abide with us. We acknowledge your presence among us with peace, trust, and thanksgiving. It is good to be with you. It is good to be with one another. Fill us with your Spirit and revel in our worship. May this time give you honor and fortify us as your people, your ambassadors,**

Welcome to all visitors: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!
If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).
If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

*PLEASE STAND IF YOU ARE ABLE

[1]UCC, WORSHIP WAYS

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Mission Highlight
The Welcome Home Initiative:
First Congregational Church of St. Albans is a founding member of the Welcome Home Initiative (WH). WH provides people transitioning from homelessness to permanent housing in Franklin and Grand Isle Counties of Vermont with new- home essentials (mop, broom, dishes, cleaners, trash can, pots & pans, etc.), personal items (shampoo, deodorant, etc.), and nonperishable food items.

The Welcome Home Initiative is a collaboration among:
Franklin/Grand Isle CVOEO- Community Action
First Congregational Church of St Albans
Grace Episcopal Church, Sheldon
Sheldon Methodist Food Shelf
Holy Trinity Episcopal Church, Swanton
Congregational Church of So. Hero
St. Luke's Episcopal Church, St. Albans
Our local Girl Scout Troop
As well as other churches and businesses that have donated to the Initiative.

WH works with local housing case workers from:
F/GI Community Action
Voices Against Violence
Samaritan House
Restorative Justice Center
Pathways
Reach-Up
Spectrum Youth and Family Services

First Congregational Church functions as the fiscal agent, collection center and pick-up hub for the program. WH serves on average 6-7 individuals/families to be housed a month.

and your agents of love and hope in the world. Amen.

HYMN*
"To You, O God, All Creatures Sing" (1,2,4) NCH 17

PRAYER OF CONFESSION[1] **(UNISON)**
Gracious and Holy God, speak to us. So often our prayer time is consumed by our words...when what we need most is your gentle nudges and your bold challenge. Let us hear from you. (Moment of silence.) As you continue to speak, prepare our hearts and minds to receive your wisdom, correction, and confirmation. Transform us for your glory, for our hope, and for the world. Amen.

PAUSE FOR REFLECTION

WORDS OF ASSURANCE

PASSING OF THE PEACE

THE MESSAGE

TIME WITH CHILDREN OF ALL AGES

SPECIAL MUSIC
Under a Tree (for Father Damien) S. Conrady

SCRIPTURE READING
Ephesians 6:10-20

MORNING REFLECTION
Sunday Best

HYMN*
"A Mighty Fortress" (1,2,4) NCH 439

THE THANKSGIVING

Sharing Our Joys and Concerns

Pastor's Prayer~

Lord's Prayer

Our Father who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, forever, Amen.

OFFERTORY

Doxology

Praise God from whom all blessing flow
Praise God all creatures here below;
Praise God above, all heavenly hosts:
Creator, Christ and Holy Ghost. Amen.

Offertory Prayer

THE DEPARTURE

Hymn*

"Blessed Assurance" (1, 3) NCH 473

Benediction

Postlude *Improvisation*

❖ END OF SERVICE ❖

Announcements:

A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:

- ❖ Clock Winders: Park Newton, Greg Beeman, Doug Klette, John Boomhover- Thank You for keeping the clock on time and the bell ringing!

Martha's Kitchen Food Drive

We are collecting the following items for Martha's Kitchen to be delivered in September. Last day of collection is September 8:

Ground Coffee, Iced Tea Mix, Sugar, Powdered Creamer

Breakfast Church Sept. 8

Praise and Pot-Luck! Everyone is welcome for this casual worship service! We will worship in the Chapel while sharing breakfast. We will pray, praise, share, and sing over delicious food and coffee! All ages welcome!

Congregational Information Meeting Sept. 8: After church

Friends and members are welcome to attend to find out everything that's happening at FCC. This is a great time to ask questions, raise concerns, and share new ideas!

Church Street Sounds of the Season returns!
Sun Sep 8 @ 3pm

Organ & more! David Neiweem (organ) and guests Katie Oprea (oboe) and Erin Grainger (mezzo-soprano) join to include Bach Cantata 170 on the program. Other program details forthcoming.

Online Giving:
Wi-Fi:
Sanctuary
sanctuary123

